

Early-morning deep synthesis. Assembles the already-baked projection bundle with the league scouting boards — nothing is recomputed. Companion to the gameday one-pager; this is the scouting-and-reasoning layer.

Fair-value readout (audit, not a directional call)

- **Fair spread:** MIN by 0.3 (model home-margin -0.3).
- **Fair projected score:** MIN 78.8 — GSV 78.9.
- **Fair total:** 157.7.
- **Rest:** GSV 2d / MIN 4d — MIN rested (+2d).
- *These are the platform's own fair lines — an audit of the model, not a directional call. No market price is quoted or implied.*

MIN — opponent scouting edges

- **Rim protection (last season):** Kayla McBride grades best among qualified defenders on the floor (SAE +6.27/100 on 61 rim shots faced). Also above-average at the rim: Maya Caldwell (+5.35), Courtney Williams (+5.17).
- **Zone scoring — Kayla McBride:** league-board shot-maker (Corner 3, +19.2 PAX/100).
- **Zone scoring — Courtney Williams:** league-board shot-maker (Short mid-range, +12.1 PAX/100).

MIN — rotation reasoning

- **Projected top-5 minutes:** Olivia Miles (29), Kayla McBride (29), Napheesa Collier (28), Courtney Williams (28), Natasha Howard (23).

GSV — opponent scouting edges

- **Rim protection (last season):** no qualified rim protector projects onto the floor (4 graded on a sub-40-shot sample — too thin to rank) — MIN's at-rim scorers face a soft interior.
- **Zone scoring — Gabby Williams:** league-board shot-maker (At the rim, +14.8 PAX/100).
- **Elite finisher:** Cecilia Zandalasini (+13.5 PAX/100 overall).
- **Efficiency watch:** Kiah Stokes (-16.0 PAX/100 overall).

GSV — rotation reasoning

- **Out (1):** Iliana Rupert — their minutes are redistributed across the rotation below.
- **Projected top-5 minutes:** Veronica Burton (26), Kayla Thornton (22), Gabby Williams (20), Kiah Stokes (20), Cecilia Zandalasini (20).
- **Provisional basis (read with caution):** Ashten Prechtel [cold_start] — projected off a thin / prior-shrunk sample, not a settled rolling rate.

Matchup implication

- **MIN at the rim:** GSV projects no qualified rim protector on the floor — MIN's interior scorers face a soft rim (last-season grades).
- **GSV at the rim:** must contend with Kayla McBride (rim SAE +6.27/100, last season) anchoring MIN's interior.

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